

## Week 1: Getting Started with Stata

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bookdown::render\_book()



# Overview

Topics:

1. Getting Started with Stata
2. Entering Data
3. Command Line, Do Files, and Results



# Chapter 1

## Getting Started

### 1.1 Introduction to Stata

Stata is a type of **statistical software package** that can be utilized for data management, data analysis, and statistics. It is similar to other types of statistical software packages compared to R, SAS, or SPSS. It can create reports, regressions, and graphics that can be incorporated into our deliverables.

I have used all of these statistical software packages. While I am a big fan of R, especially with its flexibility, I find that Stata is great for econometric analysis. In my experience Stata stands out in a few ways.

1. Stata is more powerful and flexible than SPSS (IMO)
2. Stata's syntax and processing is more streamlined/efficient than SAS (IMO)
3. Stata is easier to use than R (IMO)

### 1.2 Get Supporting Material

Before we get started with the Introduction to Stata. I want to make sure everyone is able to download the data.

```
cd "/Users/Sam/Desktop/Econ 643/AGIS/"  
net from https://www.stata-press.com/data/agis6r/  
net get agis6r
```

After we run these commands, we can check to see if the files installed on our local folder

```
ls
```

```
total 19784
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 5784501 Aug  2 15:14 altrightcombined.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff  37639 Aug  2 15:14 attitude.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   3715 Aug  2 15:14 c10interaction.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   3131 Aug  2 15:14 c11barchart.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   7650 Aug  2 15:14 census.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff    543 Aug  2 15:14 chapter1.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   4453 Aug  2 15:14 chapter10.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   2982 Aug  2 15:14 chapter11.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   3194 Aug  2 15:14 chapter12.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   1016 Aug  2 15:14 chapter13.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff  92863 Aug  2 15:14 chapter14_missing.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   1604 Aug  2 15:14 chapter14.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   3124 Aug  2 15:14 chapter15.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff    786 Aug  2 15:14 chapter16.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff    363 Aug  2 15:14 chapter2.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   2688 Aug  2 15:14 chapter3.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff    578 Aug  2 15:14 chapter4.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   1411 Aug  2 15:14 chapter5.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 267702 Aug  2 15:14 chapter6_aspirin.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   1096 Aug  2 15:14 chapter6.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   2772 Aug  2 15:14 chapter7.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   2272 Aug  2 15:14 chapter8.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   2854 Aug  2 15:14 chapter9.do
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   1845 Aug  2 15:14 chores.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff  65280 Aug  2 15:14 descriptive_gss.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   1875 Aug  2 15:14 divorce.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   1875 Aug  2 15:14 environ.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   6682 Aug  2 15:14 firstsurvey_chapter4.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   7720 Aug  2 15:14 firstsurvey.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   17530 Aug  2 15:14 flourishing_bmi.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 196040 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_and_2006_chapter12.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   71890 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_chapter10.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   70433 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_chapter11.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   54891 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_chapter6.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   36806 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_chapter7.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   48506 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_chapter7b.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   47388 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_chapter8.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   36438 Aug  2 15:14 gss2002_chapter9.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 123729 Aug  2 15:14 gss2006_chapter12_selected.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 254116 Aug  2 15:14 gss2006_chapter12.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   19937 Aug  2 15:14 gss2006_chapter6_10percent.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff   84882 Aug  2 15:14 gss2006_chapter6.dta
```



```

-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 11282 Aug 2 15:14 gss2006_chapter8_selected.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 143277 Aug 2 15:14 gss2006_chapter8.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 73780 Aug 2 15:14 gss2006_chapter9_2way.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 63099 Aug 2 15:14 gss2006_chapter9.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 64584 Aug 2 15:14 gss2016_chapter12.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 4563 Aug 2 15:14 highjump.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 1974 Aug 2 15:14 intraclass.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 23745 Aug 2 15:14 irt_exercises.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 2102 Aug 2 15:14 kappa1.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 13444 Aug 2 15:14 kuder-richardson.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 1915 Aug 2 15:14 long.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 108658 Aug 2 15:14 longitudinal_exercise.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 63905 Aug 2 15:14 longitudinal_mixed.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 615085 Aug 2 15:14 nlsy97_chapter11.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 58476 Aug 2 15:14 nlsy97_chapter7.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 541933 Aug 2 15:14 nlsy97_selected_variables.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 166013 Aug 2 15:14 ops2004.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 4663 Aug 2 15:14 partyid.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 7809 Aug 2 15:14 relate.cdb
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 225118 Aug 2 15:14 relate.dct
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 402891 Aug 2 15:14 relate.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 1855 Aug 2 15:14 retest.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 5955 Aug 2 15:14 severity.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 3165 Aug 2 15:14 spearman.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 1875 Aug 2 15:14 wide.dta
-rw-r--r-- 1 Sam staff 4529 Aug 2 15:14 wide9.dta

```

We will be utilizing these data and do files throughout the course.

Also, I will be working with Stata 19, but it is okay if you are working with Stata 17 or Stata 18.

## 1.3 Stata Screen

For those who have never used Stata before. Let's navigate the screen.

The **output** or **results** window is the middle of the screen and provides the largest section in Stata.

Below the **output** window is the **command line** window. Here you can enter ad hoc commands. I personally find these very helpful with data exploration using the *tabulate* or *sum* commands.

On the left-most side is the **command history** window. This will show prior commands that you have run through the **command line**. This is helpful if you need to copy something over to a **do file** or run a prior command.

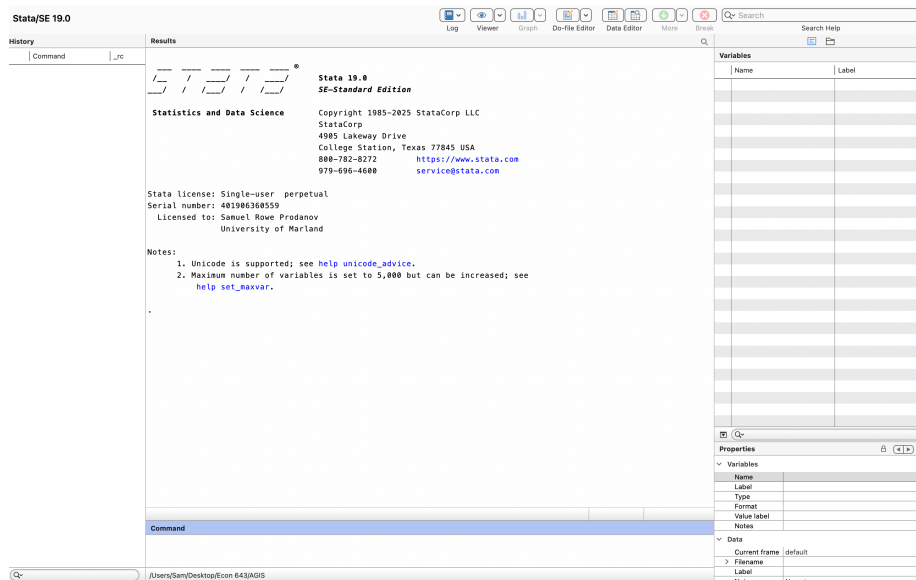


Figure 1.1: Stata Window

In the upper right, we have the **variable** window. This window provides information about the variables in your dataset. Once you select a variable in the **variable** window, information about the variable appears in the lower-right window or **variable property** window.

Stata's Toolbar provides helpful quick clicks for Stata's Tools

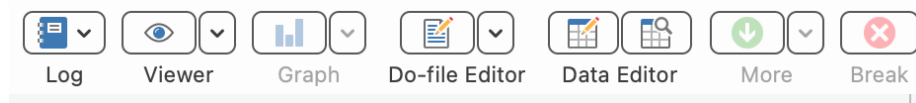


Figure 1.2: Stata toolbar for OSX

The most important button is going to be the **Do-File Editor** button. This is where you do the majority of your work in Stata. The table with the magnifying glass is another important button for a quick click to the **Browser** window.

## 1.4 Our First Dataset

Please note that we will be working through the **Do-File editor**. We will not be using the point-and-click method

Let's go ahead and use a dataset in memory. We will use the command *sysuse* with the option *clear*.

```
sysuse cancer, clear
```

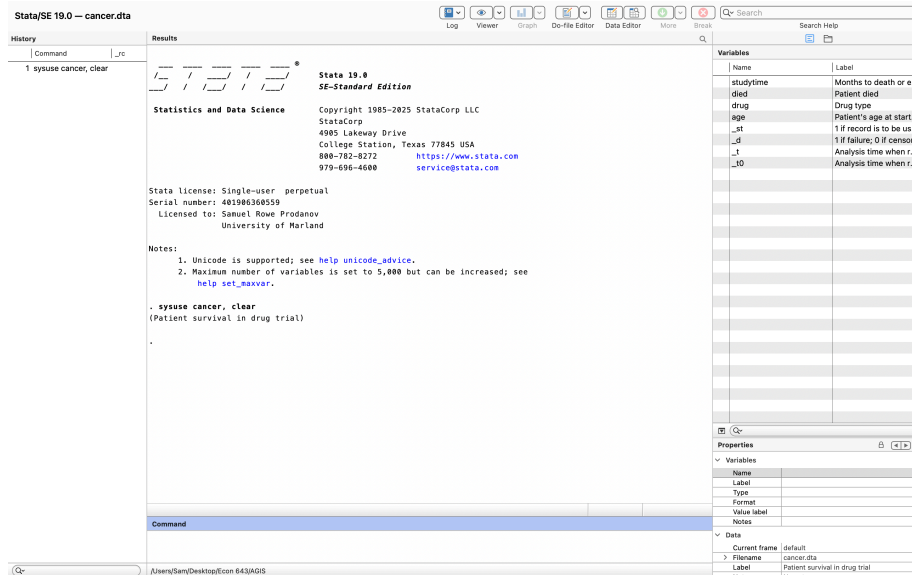


Figure 1.3: Stata Window with Data Loaded

Now we have loaded a dataset into Stata, we can see that our windows have changed. Our results window says

```
. sysuse cancer, clear (Patient survival in drug trial)
```

Our **Command History** window shows our last command. Our variables in the memory are shown in the **Variable** window.

## 1.5 Run commands

### 1.5.1 describe

Next let's run some commands to do some small analyses. Let's look at the data with the *describe* command.

```
describe
```

```
Contains data from /Applications/Stata/ado/base/c/cancer.dta
Observations:      48      Patient survival in drug trial
Variables:         8      3 Mar 2024 16:09
```

| Variable<br>name | Storage<br>type | Display<br>format | Value<br>label | Variable label                            |
|------------------|-----------------|-------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------|
| studytime        | byte            | %8.0g             |                | Months to death or end of exp.            |
| died             | byte            | %8.0g             | diedlbl        | Patient died                              |
| drug             | byte            | %8.0g             | type           | Drug type                                 |
| age              | byte            | %8.0g             |                | Patient's age at start of exp.            |
| _st              | byte            | %8.0g             |                | 1 if record is to be used; 0<br>otherwise |
| _d               | byte            | %8.0g             |                | 1 if failure; 0 if censored               |
| _t               | byte            | %10.0g            |                | Analysis time when record ends            |
| _t0              | byte            | %10.0g            |                | Analysis time when record begins          |

Sorted by:

The *describe* command gives us an overview of the dataset. It provides the variable name, storage type, display format, value label, and variable label. We can see that all of our data are numeric and have variable labels to describe the variable, but only two variables have labels for the values.

### 1.5.2 summarize

Next, we can run basic descriptive statistics for all of our variables with the *summarize* or *sum* command.

```
summarize
```

| Variable  | Obs | Mean     | Std. dev. | Min | Max |
|-----------|-----|----------|-----------|-----|-----|
| studytime | 48  | 15.5     | 10.25629  | 1   | 39  |
| died      | 48  | .6458333 | .4833211  | 0   | 1   |
| drug      | 48  | 1.875    | .8410986  | 1   | 3   |
| age       | 48  | 55.875   | 5.659205  | 47  | 67  |
| _st       | 48  | 1        | 0         | 1   | 1   |
| _d        | 48  | .6458333 | .4833211  | 0   | 1   |
| _t        | 48  | 15.5     | 10.25629  | 1   | 39  |
| _t0       | 48  | 0        | 0         | 0   | 0   |

Our basic descriptive statistics show that the average age is 55.9 years old with a standard deviation of 5.7. Our maximum age is 67 and the minimum age is 47.

### 1.5.3 histogram

Next we can graph the distribution of our *age* variable. AGIS shows how to create a histogram with the point and click, but we are going straight to syntax. No point in delaying the inevitable.

```
histogram age
```

```
(bin=6, start=47, width=3.333333)
```

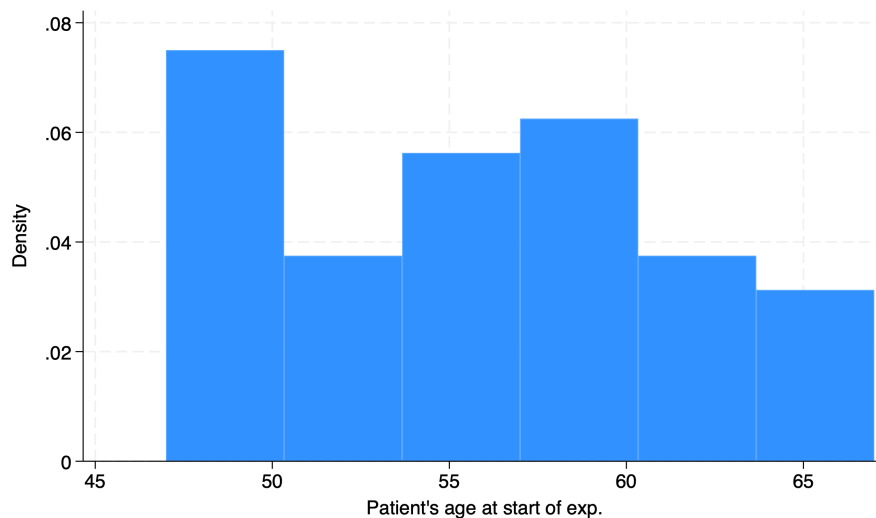


Figure 1.4: Our first histogram

We can format the histogram with options. We can edit the bins and the width of the histogram with the *bin()* option or *width()* options. Options are established after the *,* in a command. We will also start at age 45 with the *start* option and increment by 2.5 with *width(2.5)*. We can also edit the title with the *title()* option and cite the source of the data with the *caption()* option.

```
histogram age, title("Age distribution of participants in cancer study") caption("Cancer Dataset")
```

```
(bin=6, start=47, width=3.333333)
```

We can see the number of bins has increased and the width of the bins is 2.5 years. We have also added a title and a source of the data.

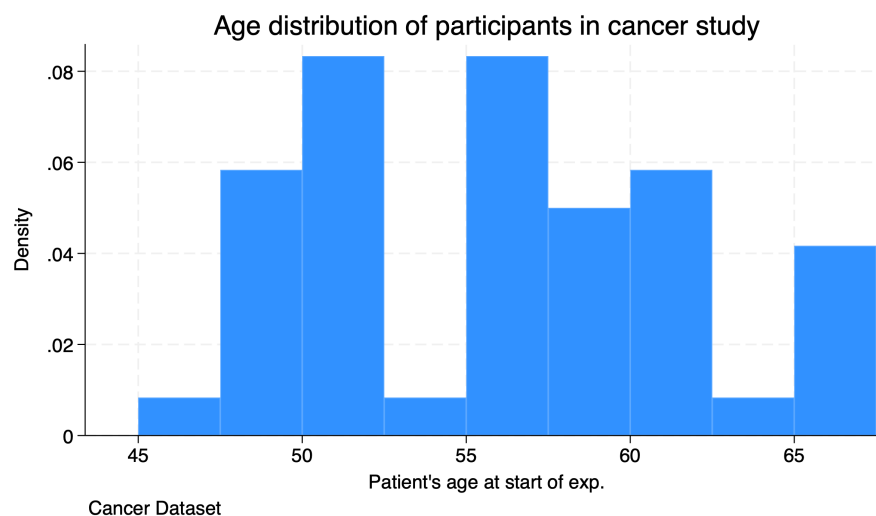


Figure 1.5: Formatted Histogram

## 1.6 Help and Search

Before we get started, I wanted to talk about two helpful commands.

```
help tabulate  
search tabulate
```

The *help* command displays help information about the specified command or topic, while the *search* command search Stata documentation and other resources. These can be utilized to gather additional information about commands or topics.

## Chapter 2

# Entering Data

Before we begin this section, I recommend not working directly in Stata’s data editor. This is a personal preference, and you are more than welcome to work directly in the data editor. I generally recommend working in a spreadsheet software and importing the data into Stata. However, we will cover some basics.

If you need to edit data, I recommend using the *replace* command which we will cover later.

**Please note that if you need to edit data, do not do an ad-hoc edits. Import raw data and use syntax to be transparent!**

### 2.1 ETL

We will use using an “ETL” philosophy. This acronym stands for “Extract”, “Transform”, “Load”. We will “Extract” data from its source, so external audience can see the raw data. We will use the *use* or *import using* commands to extract our from our source data. We will cover more on the *import* command when we get to Mitchell (2020).

Next, we need to “Transform” the data. We will be using the *generate* and *replace* command to show external users how we made edits. Data transformations in source data can be opaque. We want transparency!

Finally, we will “Load” the data. What we are doing here is exporting our data analyses and graphs into our final product, such as presentations and articles. Stata has a variety of methods to create data table that can be used in Word or LaTeX.

## 2.2 The Data Editor

If we want to manually enter data into stata, **which I do not recommend**, we can start Stata's data editor. One way is to use the quick click on the toolbar. This is the icon with the table and the pencil.

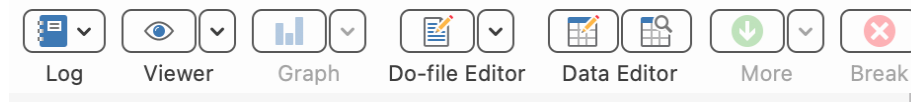


Figure 2.1: Data Editor in the Toolbar

We can also launch the data editor by typing `edit` into the command line.

```
edit
```

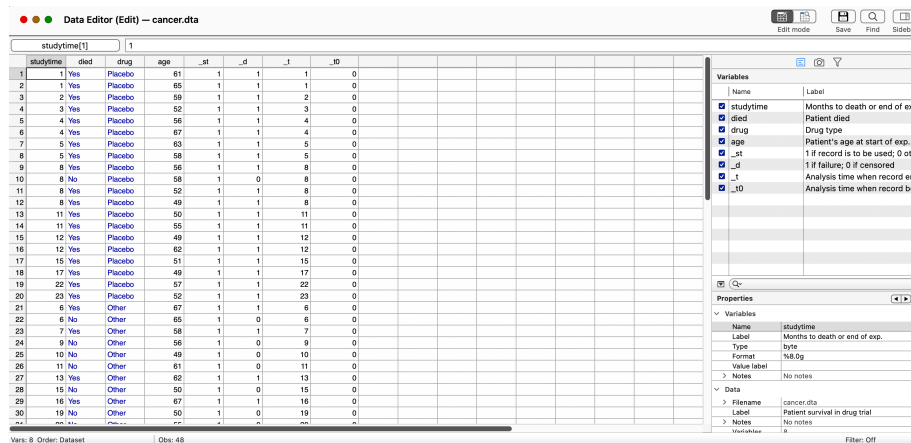


Figure 2.2: Data Editor

I will not delve into this chapter any farther, since we will use syntax to create, edit, or delete variables. This includes labeling our data. **Use syntax!**



## Chapter 3

# Commands, Do Files, and Results

I don't spend much time on Data Editor, since we should be doing data transformations within our reproducible syntax in our do files. This will be our focus moving forward.

Why use do files? My two main points are the following: 1. Efficiency 2. Transparency

**Efficiency:** Your future time required to do routine tasks drops immensely once your syntax works. Not only can it reduce time for a routine task, you can take snippets of your syntax for other do files. No point in reinventing the wheel! Point and click may be faster up front, but on routine tasks point-and-clicks get left in the dust compared to syntax.

**Transparency:** You can provide evidence of your work. An independent person can take the source data independency, and apply your syntax to see if they get similar results. Not only that, they can check for any shenanigans within the syntax. You will see data replication packages in journals of the *American Economic Association*.

### 3.1 Commands

Before we start working with do files, we should have a base repository of commands, so we can work with data. We will cover other commands, such as *ttest*, *anova*, and *regress* a bit later.

| Variables | Description                                              |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| use       | Put a Stata .dta file into Stata's memory                |
| sysuse    | Put a shipped or build-in data file into Stata's memory  |
| import    | Put a non-Stata file, such as .xlsx, into Stata's memory |
| cd        | Change working directory                                 |
| list      | List of the values of variables                          |
| summarize | Summary statistics                                       |
| describe  | Describe the data in memory or in file                   |
| codebook  | Describe the data contents                               |
| tabulate  | Tables of frequencies                                    |
| generate  | Create a variable                                        |
| replace   | Change contents of a variable                            |
| egen      | Extensions to generate                                   |
| graph     | The graph command                                        |
| histogram | Creates a histogram                                      |
| save      | Saves a file to designated folder                        |
| missing   | Is missing                                               |

These commands will be workhorses for you, so it is good to begin working with them now.

```
sysuse Mroz, clear
summarize lwg, detail
```

| Log wage rate. Actual wage, or for lfp=0 imputed<br>by regressing lwg on other vars |             |           |             |           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------|-------------|-----------|
| -----                                                                               |             |           |             |           |
|                                                                                     | Percentiles | Smallest  |             |           |
| 1%                                                                                  | -.6931472   | -2.054124 |             |           |
| 5%                                                                                  | .2066842    | -1.822531 |             |           |
| 10%                                                                                 | .4953217    | -1.766441 | Obs         | 753       |
| 25%                                                                                 | .8180865    | -1.543298 | Sum of wgt. | 753       |
| 50%                                                                                 | 1.068403    |           | Mean        | 1.097115  |
|                                                                                     |             | Largest   | Std. dev.   | .5875564  |
| 75%                                                                                 | 1.399717    | 3.113515  |             |           |
| 90%                                                                                 | 1.760261    | 3.155581  | Variance    | .3452226  |
| 95%                                                                                 | 2.083896    | 3.218876  | Skewness    | -.3992074 |
| 99%                                                                                 | 2.733368    | 3.218876  | Kurtosis    | 7.040145  |

We can dig deeper into the command by looking up the options of these command. We can look up the options for the *summarize* command with the following:

```
help summarize
```

## 3.2 Qualifiers

We may want to qualify for conditional commands. We may want to look at subsets when analyzing data or apply a command under certain conditions. Stata's list of qualifiers is the following:

| RelationalOperators | Description               |
|---------------------|---------------------------|
| ==                  | is or is equal to         |
| !=                  | is not or is not equal to |
| ~=                  | is not or is not equal to |
| >                   | greater than              |
| >=                  | greater than or equal to  |
| <                   | less than                 |
| <=                  | less than or equal to     |

| LogicalOperators | Description |
|------------------|-------------|
| &                | And         |
|                  | Or          |
| !                | Not         |

We can combine the commands with qualifiers. We can combine the *Not* operator with the missing command to find observations where age is not missing.

```
sysuse Mroz, clear
summarize lwg if !missing(age)
tab lfp if age >= 55
```

| Variable    | Obs | Mean     | Std. dev. | Min       | Max      |
|-------------|-----|----------|-----------|-----------|----------|
| -----+----- |     |          |           |           |          |
| lwg         | 753 | 1.097115 | .5875564  | -2.054124 | 3.218876 |

| Labor-force        |       |         |        |
|--------------------|-------|---------|--------|
| participation      | Freq. | Percent | Cum.   |
| -----+-----        |       |         |        |
| Not in labor force | 31    | 56.36   | 56.36  |
| In labor force     | 24    | 43.64   | 100.00 |
| -----+-----        |       |         |        |
| Total              | 55    | 100.00  |        |

Our *summarize* command with a not missing qualifier show the natural log of wages when age is not missing.

Our *tabulate* command shows the labor force participation of individuals aged 55 or older.

### 3.3 Do-File Editor

Let's click the button to open a new do-file editor to write our first do file. Optionally, we can use the command line with the following:

```
doedit
```

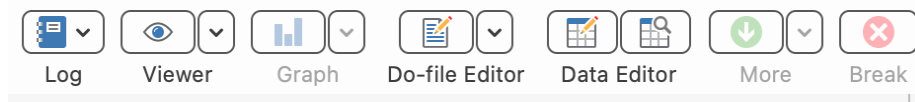


Figure 3.1: Stata Toolbar on OSX

Once we click the do-file editor button or type in *doedit*, a blank do file will appear.

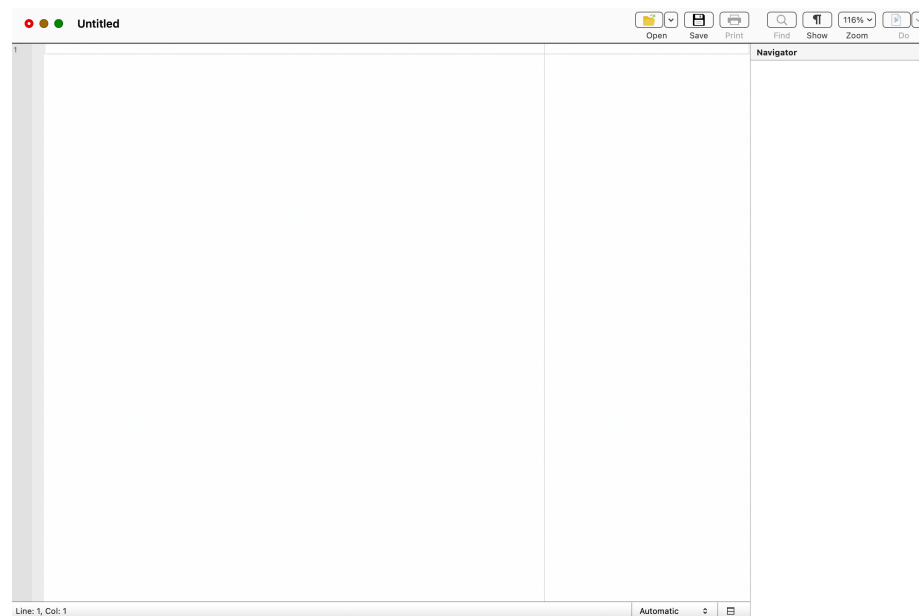
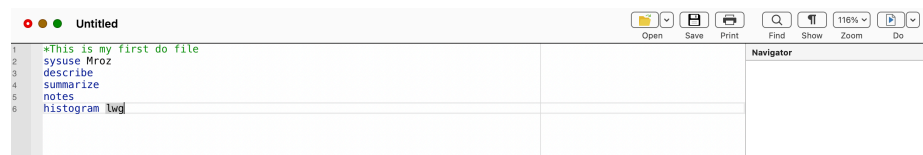


Figure 3.2: Blank Do File

Let's go ahead and write our first do file.



It should look like this.

Either click the “Do” button or press Ctrl+D for Windows or Shift+Command+D for OSX. Please note that you have some options with the do drop down menu.

```
*This is my first do file
sysuse Mroz
describe
summarize
histogram lwg
```

Contains data from /Users/Sam/Library/Application Support/Stata/ado/plus/M/Mroz.dt  
> a

```
Observations:      753
Variables:         8                2 May 2021 01:02
```

| Variable name | Storage type | Display format | Value label | Variable label                                                                   |
|---------------|--------------|----------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| k5            | byte         | %8.0g          |             | Number of children 5 years old or younger                                        |
| k618          | byte         | %8.0g          |             | Number of children 6 to 17 years old                                             |
| age           | byte         | %8.0g          |             | Age in years                                                                     |
| lwg           | float        | %9.0g          |             | Log wage rate. Actual wage, or for lfp=0 imputed by regressing lwg on other vars |
| inc           | float        | %9.0g          |             | Family income exclusive of wife\'s income                                        |
| lfp           | byte         | %18.0g         | lf          | Labor-force participation                                                        |
| wc            | byte         | %27.0g         | wcg         | Wife attended college                                                            |
| hc            | byte         | %9.0g          | hcg         |                                                                                  |

Sorted by:

| Variable | Obs | Mean     | Std. dev. | Min       | Max      |
|----------|-----|----------|-----------|-----------|----------|
| k5       | 753 | .2377158 | .523959   | 0         | 3        |
| k618     | 753 | 1.353254 | 1.319874  | 0         | 8        |
| age      | 753 | 42.53785 | 8.072574  | 30        | 60       |
| lwg      | 753 | 1.097115 | .5875564  | -2.054124 | 3.218876 |
| inc      | 753 | 20.12897 | 11.6348   | -.029     | 96       |
| lfp      | 753 | .5683931 | .4956295  | 0         | 1        |
| wc       | 753 | .2815405 | .4500494  | 0         | 1        |
| hc       | 753 | .3917663 | .4884694  | 0         | 1        |

(bin=27, start=-2.0541239, width=.19529629)

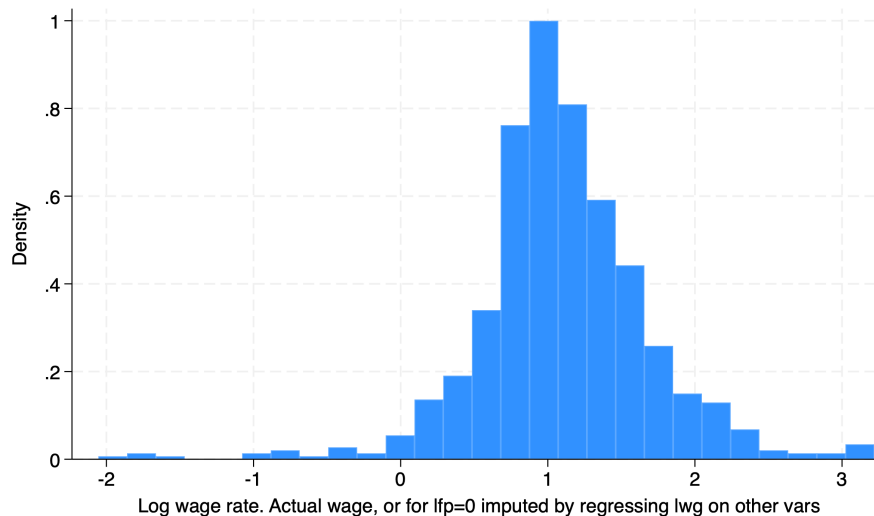


Figure 3.3: Histogram of natural log of wages from our first do file

### 3.4 Exporting Results

We'll start off with some very simple exporting of our results. We'll delve into better ETL tools later, but for now we will stick with the right-click copy-and-paste method.

Please note that I'm not a fan of the right-click copy-and-paste method, since it requires user input to complete. Acock (2020) provides a hint at some of Stata's tools for exporting results. This includes:

1. *esttab*
2. *etable*
3. *putexcel*
4. *putdocx*
5. *putpdf*
6. *markdown*
7. *dyndoc*

Highlight your do file for all the rows except for the histogram. Click the drop down menu for the “Do” button and select “execute selection”.

Now we have some output let's highlight the results and right click for options. Let's say we want to paste our table right into a Word document. We can select “Copy as picture”. If we wanted to paste the results into an Excel file, we can select “Copy as table”. If we wanted to paste right into a html file, we can select “Copy as HTML”.

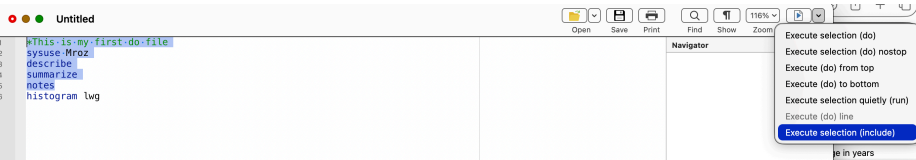


Figure 3.4: Highlight Do File

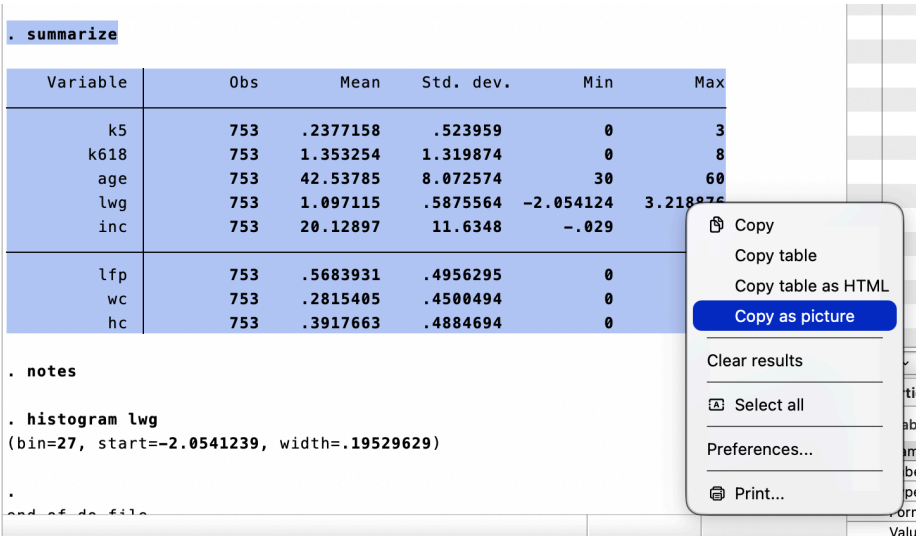


Figure 3.5: Highlight Results

Now we can go to our Word document and paste it.

Here is our Word document and we will paste our Stata results here:

```
. summarize
```

| Variable | Obs | Mean     | Std. dev. | Min       | Max      |
|----------|-----|----------|-----------|-----------|----------|
| k5       | 753 | .2377158 | .523959   | 0         | 3        |
| k618     | 753 | 1.353254 | 1.319874  | 0         | 8        |
| age      | 753 | 42.53785 | 8.072574  | 30        | 60       |
| lwg      | 753 | 1.097115 | .5875564  | -2.054124 | 3.218876 |
| inc      | 753 | 20.12897 | 11.6348   | -.029     | 96       |
| lfp      | 753 | .5683931 | .4956295  | 0         | 1        |
| wc       | 753 | .2815405 | .4500494  | 0         | 1        |
| hc       | 753 | .3917663 | .4884694  | 0         | 1        |

Figure 3.6: Paste our Stata results into Word

We can also export out in LaTeX, which we will discuss next week with the LyX word processor. Another option is Overleaf for working with LaTeX.

Or, we can utilize Stata with RMarkdown as you see here. These pages are built with the Bookdown package that utilizes RMarkdown with Stata being called.

### 3.5 Logs

We will cover log files a bit later in Mitchel (2020). But as a preview, you will need to use log files for your homework. However, I recommend not using log files until your syntax is working well. I have had plenty of do files fail to run since a log file was not properly closed during testing.



## Chapter 4

# References

Acock, A.C. (2023). A gentle introduction to Stata. 6th ed. Stata Press

Mitchell, M. N. (2020). Data management using Stata: A practical handbook. Stata Press.